

SAMPATH THENNAKOON

Lead Software Engineer | Technical Lead

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software engineer and technical lead with 14+ years building backend platforms in FinTech, e-commerce, retail and insurance. Leads a team of eight at Lendo across the full lending platform, where recent work includes migrating 13+ services from Java 8 to Java 21 and 25, raising test coverage from ~60% to over 80%, and setting the review standards for the team's adoption of AI-assisted development. Previously a founding engineer on a multi-tenant pharmaceutical e-commerce platform serving 10,000+ US customers and 1,000+ orders a day. MSc in Computer Science (Data Science), University of Moratuwa.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lendo

Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

Lead Software Engineer / Team Lead

Jan 2025 – Present

- Lead a team of eight engineers across the full Lendo platform — consumer system, admin system and business registration — owning system design, delivery and production support end to end.
- Migrated 13+ backend services (loan management, user management, transaction management and the BFF layers) from Java 8 to Java 21, and introduced Java 25 in several services: adopted virtual threads, tuned GC and database connection pooling, and upgraded the dependency tree. Measured before and after on latency, throughput, pod count and open CVEs, cutting pod count and vulnerabilities while improving latency and throughput.
- Migrated all backend services from PostgreSQL to Oracle, building a custom tool to carry out the data migration.
- Raised test coverage from ~60% to over 80%, building out unit and integration suites across the codebase and holding the standard through structured review and mentoring.
- Introduced AI-assisted development (Claude Code, GitLab Duo) across the team and wrote the review policy and guardrails for AI-generated code, using it to drive the test-coverage and database migration work above.

Aeturnum Inc.

Sri Lanka

Tech Lead → Senior Tech Lead

Jan 2022 – Dec 2024

- Founding engineer on a multi-tenant pharmaceutical e-commerce platform for the US market, built by around 30 engineers across five streams (Core, POS, Loyalty, Data and Payments). Designed the base system, set the engineering guidelines and built the initial prototype, then led delivery as Tech Lead.
- Shipped the first release in seven months in 2023 without AI tooling, then held a weekly release cadence. By the end of 2024 the platform served 10,000+ customers and over 1,000 orders a day.
- Designed for the constraints that shaped the platform: prescription rules and regulatory requirements that vary by US region, inventory synchronization with in-store POS systems, and peak-season load.
- Ran the inventory data migration from the client's CMS into MongoDB Atlas, and introduced a dedicated load-testing environment ahead of peak trading.

University of Moratuwa

Sri Lanka

Graduate Researcher — MSc Thesis on Vision-Based Human Activity Recognition System

Apr 2021 – Dec 2021

- Designed and built a vision-based analytics platform applying deep learning and computer vision, as the research component of the MSc in Data Science.

Zone24x7 Inc.

Sri Lanka

Associate Technical Lead

May 2019 – Mar 2021

- Built the feature engineering and model training for a machine-learning shopping-intent system for Kohl's, a major US retailer.
- Led development of an inventory management system and a device-monitoring platform covering 1,000+ devices across 10+ large-format Kohl's stores, including patching and upgrade rollout.
- Delivered data-migration middleware for Brandix Apparel, the Goods2U and SafeTrack COVID-19 logistics platforms, and telco features for Circlelife.

Last Updated On – 03.10.2026

Cinglevue International

Senior Developer

Sri Lanka

Nov 2017 – May 2019

- Built core modules of the Virtuoso education management system and Virtuoso ERP for institutional clients in the education sector.

Intervest Software Technologies

Software Engineer → Senior Software Engineer

Sri Lanka

Nov 2011 – Nov 2017

- Built and maintained quotation, policy management and payment features (C#/.NET) for the Staysure and Avanti travel and home insurance platforms in the UK market, handling 500+ quotes a day and over 10,000 policies a year.
- Worked directly with UK business stakeholders from requirements through release over six years, progressing from Software Engineer to Senior Software Engineer.

IFS R&D International

Senior Software Engineer

Sri Lanka

Aug 2016 – Dec 2017

- Freelance (concurrent, 2016–2017): built a combined CRM, telecoms and solar energy management system for ITO2 Labs.

IFS R&D International

Trainee Software Engineer (Internship)

Sri Lanka

Aug 2010 – Dec 2010

- Contributed to the IFS Human Resource Management System within the R&D engineering team.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java (8–25), Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, C#/.NET

Backend: Spring Boot, Quarkus, Spring Cloud, Microservices, Node JS, Flask

Streaming & data: Apache Kafka, Apache Flink (Cinglevue, Zone24x7), PostgreSQL, Oracle, MySQL, MongoDB

Cloud & DevOps: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, CI/CD (GitLab)

Practices: Agile/Scrum, TDD, Code Review, System Design, AI-Assisted Development (Claude Code, GitLab Duo)

Data & ML (MSc thesis, Kohl's work): PyTorch, TensorFlow

EDUCATION

MSc in Computer Science (Specialization in Data Science)

2020 – 2023

University of Moratuwa, Sri Lanka

BSc in Management & Information Technology

2008 – 2011

University of Kelaniya, Sri Lanka

CERTIFICATIONS

- Java 21 Virtual Threads and Structured Concurrency — Udemy, Apr 2025
- Apache Flink: Real-Time Data Engineering — LinkedIn Learning, Jun 2024
- PyTorch for Deep Learning and Computer Vision — Udemy, Sep 2023
- Sun Certified Java Programmer (SCJP 6) — Oracle/Sun, License SW409182

LANGUAGES

- English — IELTS 6.0 (CEFR B2)
- German — B1 (Institut-Zertifikat)
- Sinhala — native